YELEN DIGITAL

Illuminating your brand

PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR SMALL BUSINESSES

7 SIGNALS

THAT DAMAGE THE ONLINE IMAGE OF YOUR SMALL BUSINESS

The 10-minute test to find out where you stand.

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BEFORE YOU START

Your customer has already judged you.

Before calling you, writing to you or visiting, your future customer does one thing: they look you up on their phone. They have a few seconds to decide whether to trust you.

This guide gives you **7 signals** to check. Each one takes 2 minutes to test, with your own phone.

HOW TO USE IT

1. Grab your phone.
2. Search for your business the way a customer would.
3. Tick each signal you pass, then add up your score out of 7 (last page).

> *Be strict. A customer won't cut you any slack.*

01

PROFILE AND BIO

Your first impression

IN THE FIELD RESTAURANT

The Instagram profile shows a lovely logo, but no opening hours, no address, no WhatsApp number. The hungry customer moves on to the next one.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

A booking lost before it began. Visitors don't ask the question: they leave.

THE BENCHMARK

In 5 seconds, people should understand what you do, where you are and how to reach you.

2-MINUTE TEST

Open your profile as a stranger would, without scrolling.

Passed if: activity, location and contact are visible immediately.

☐ I pass this signal

02

VISUAL CONSISTENCY

A brand, not a photo album

IN THE FIELD — CLOTHING BOUTIQUE

Every post has its own style: different filters, mixed fonts, photos taken at random. The shop looks like a jumble.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

An image that doesn't inspire trust, so prices you no longer dare to defend.

THE BENCHMARK

Same colours, same photo style, same tone, across all your posts.

2-MINUTE TEST

Display your last 9 posts at a glance.

Passed if: people recognise you without reading your name.

☐ I pass this signal

03

CONSISTENT POSTING

A living shopfront

IN THE FIELD HAIR SALON

Three posts in January, then six weeks of silence. For the customer, the salon may have closed.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Doubt. An abandoned account says: “this business is no longer active”.

THE BENCHMARK

At least one post a week, on fixed days.

2-MINUTE TEST

Note the dates of your posts over the last two months.

Passed if: there is never a gap of more than 10 days.

☐ I pass this signal

04

SOCIAL PROOF

What others say about you

IN THE FIELD MEDICAL PRACTICE

No Google reviews, no testimonials. Someone who is hesitating has nothing to reassure them.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

A new customer won't take your word for it. They believe those who came before.

THE BENCHMARK

Reviews, testimonials, photos of your work: visible without having to search.

2-MINUTE TEST

Type your business name into Google and look at your reviews.

Passed if: you have at least 10 recent reviews and a rating of 4 or above.

☐ I pass this signal

05

GOOGLE MY BUSINESS

Be found on Google

IN THE FIELD CRAFT WORKSHOP

Excellent work, but no Google listing. The customer who types “carpenter in Dakar” never finds this workshop.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

You work well, but only your visible competitors benefit.

THE BENCHMARK

Claimed listing, up-to-date hours, photos, phone number and exact address.

2-MINUTE TEST

On your phone, type your trade followed by your neighbourhood.

Passed if: you appear on the map, with hours and photos.

☐ I pass this signal

06

RESPONSIVENESS

Reply before your competitor

IN THE FIELD TRAINING CENTRE

Enrolment requests arrive by message and go unanswered for days. The applicant enrols elsewhere.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

A customer who writes is ready to buy. Every hour of silence pushes them away.

THE BENCHMARK

A reply within the day, on all your channels: messages, comments, WhatsApp.

2-MINUTE TEST

Count the messages and comments left unanswered.

Passed if: no message has been waiting for more than 24 hours.

☐ I pass this signal

07

MEASUREMENT

Know what works

IN THE FIELD SHOP

The owner posts every day, but doesn't know which post brought in a sale. She starts over at random.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Time and money spent without knowing what pays off.

THE BENCHMARK

Three numbers tracked every month: reach, engagement, enquiries received.

2-MINUTE TEST

Name your best post from last month and explain why it worked.

Passed if: you can answer without looking it up.

☐ I pass this signal

YOUR SCORE

Where do you stand?

One point per signal passed.

7 out of 7	A solid foundation. The real question becomes growth: going further, faster.
5-6 out of 7	Good foundations, but leaks. Every missing point is a customer who walks past you.
3-4 out of 7	Your presence is working against you on several fronts. A serious customer will hesitate.
0-2 out of 7	Today, your online presence is costing you customers, without you seeing it.

Send us your score.

Simply reply to this message with your score (example: 4/7). We'll tell you in a few lines where to start.

Rosalie Gueye Founder, Yelen Digital

yelendigital.com | Instagram @yelen_digital